

Opera mini

Hybrid browser to lead Opera's charge by building Opera Mini into Opera Mobile.
<http://cnet.co/2kfeCm>

**Lenovo N5902**

For home theater buffs, Lenovo's latest multimedia keyboard offering ditches its predecessor's glossy black finish for a matte black one

Boxee Box media streamer

Expensive Perfection

The Boxee Box is a part HD media player and part HD media streamer. As one device, it attempts to do the best of what the WD Live HD media player series does and also what Apple TV does. And it does so while looking very unique. One look at the form factor, and you know this Box will stand out from all the other gadgets in your home theatre console. However, size-wise, the Boxee is much bigger than the WD Live, WD Live Hub and the puck sized Apple TV. No let up in connectivity options—HDMI out, optical audio out, two USB inputs and a memory card slot. No internal storage space though, unlike the WD Live Hub. An Intel Atom processor powers the Boxee and some inbuilt storage to install apps and save temp files.

However, that size difference can be forgotten the moment you see the performance. The HD up-scaling quality does depend on tweaking the settings correctly. In the video settings, select De-interlacing policy to “never, unless scaling”, De-ringing filter and Gaussian filter off. Why we say this is because with the two filters switched on, we found a bit of noise in both HD and SD video content. However, with both turned off, the picture quality was absolutely fantastic. Compared side by side to the WD Live with the same content, the Boxee was just that much better. What also helps is the fact that the colour depth level can be bumped up to 36-bit, as compared to a max 12-bit on the WD Live. File playback is pretty much seamless off a USB

storage device. It handled all file formats we threw at it.

What the Boxee handles much better than the WD Live is the video streaming bit – off the PC on the same network. While the WD Live depends on software such as PS3 Media Server and TVersity, Boxee has its own Boxee Media Manager app for the PC and Mac. Select the folders from within the app, connect the Boxee via a wired connection to the same network, and it will immediately detect those folders in the File Menu. The streaming does work well off a wired connection. We played back SD videos without any stuttering. Most 720p HD videos also played back without stutters. However, 1080p HD videos will stutter, depending on the router limitations. Weirdly, the volume control doesn't work when you are streaming an HD video (.mkv format, usually).

The remote that comes with the Boxee is just brilliant. One side is a bunch of keys- direction, menu, play/pause and return on a glossy form factor. On the other side is a full-fledged QWERTY keypad. That is useful when accessing web

Speaking of which, the variety of web content is quite good. However, we do get limited content in our geographical location. For example, Netflix doesn't work here. However, you do get apps such as Grooveshark, TuneIN Radio, YouTube and even a web browser. The browser does render web sites quite well, and was much better than what we expected.

Overall, the Boxee is a bit of this and a bit of that device. It works well as an HD media player when you connect a USB drive to it. It works equally well when you are streaming videos to it from a PC on the same network. We do not get the exciting apps such as Netflix in India, so that basically reduces the services to a similar level as the rivals. The variety is definitely more with the Boxee but we aren't sure how many of those you will use. The price of ₹13,999 is definitely on the expensive side. And that is the only real fault we can find with this device. You may want to check out the WD Live Hub — costs about ₹11.5k and comes with 1TB storage space.

Vishal Mathur



Specifications

Intel Atom processor
 HD media streamer
 1080p upscale resolution
 2 USB ports
 Memory card slot

Contact

D-Link India

Email: helpdesk@dlink.co.in

Contact: +91-22-27626600

Price: ₹13,999

7.0
/ 10

Features 8.0
 Performance..... 7.5
 Build Quality 7.5
 Value for Money 5.5